

Chapter 1: Introduction

1.1 Background

Volcanism at the Earth's surface is a geologically important process that originates due to partial melting of the Earth's convecting mantle and subsequent melt segregation. Partial melting generates the oceanic and continental crust and determines the large-scale chemical evolution of the Earth. Moreover, similar processes may occur on other terrestrial planets. Most of the Earth's mantle is generally below its melting point, while partial melting occurs in the following three tectonic settings.

Mid-ocean ridges: Upwelling of the convecting mantle beneath mid-ocean ridges leads to decompression melting and generates the oceanic crust.

Hot-spots: Thermal anomalies induce melting beneath hot-spots and generate ocean islands and oceanic plateaus as well as flood basalt provinces on the continents.

Subduction zones: The addition of fluids that lower the melting point induces flux-melting above the dehydrating down-going oceanic crust and generates the continental crust.

Schmeling (2000)

1.2 Notable Existing Softwares

ASPECT : solve a Stokes system describing the movement of solid mantle material. "However, this will not consider melt extraction or any relative movement between melt and solid and there might be problems where the transport of melt is of interest".

TerraFERMA : A high level wrapper for Fenics and Petsc.

pMELTS: Thermodynamics simulation of melting and freezing. Mechanical behaviors and transport not emphasized.

1.3 Outline

Chapter 2: Coupled Simulation

Now we couple locally mass conserved MFEM and FVM method together in this chapter and perform coupled numerical simulation for partially molten mantle. We discuss implementation details and coupling strategy combining MFEM, FVM and eutectic phase package. The remaining uncertainty of porosity ϕ will be fulfilled by phase package evaluation. Before we throw ourselves into the fully coupled problem. We test another porosity evolution scenario with a more straightforward prescribed melting. Then we will show an example combining MFEM, FVM and eutectic phase package altogether and perform coupled computation. We start with pseudo 1D scenarios and then proceed to perform full 2D simulation.

2.1 Coupled Algorithm

Let $\mathcal{U}^n = (C^n, H^n)$ be the cell-averaged solution to the transport system (??) at time t^n . Let $\mathcal{V}^n = (\check{\mathbf{v}}_r^n, \check{\mathbf{v}}_s^n, \check{q}_l^n, \check{q}_s^n)$ denote the solution to the Darcy-Stokes system at the same time step t^n . Moreover, let $\mathcal{W}^n = (\phi^n, \phi_1^n, \check{T}^n, c_s^n, c_l^n)$ denote the output of the phase calculation at t^n given the transport result U^n .

For each time step t^n , we reconstruct dimensionless mass composition and enthalpy from the cell-averaged solution $\mathcal{U}^n$ with ML-WENO reconstruction at each data points. The eutectic phase package gives corresponding phase parameters $\mathcal{W}^n$ according to these point wise values. Once we know $\mathcal{W}^n$, we solve a fixed in time Darcy-Stokes system at this time step t^n for $\mathcal{V}^n$. The cell-averaged solution $\mathcal{U}^{n+1}$ of the next time step t^{n+1} is then obtained by forward marching the system explicitly. We formally formulate an overall explicit coupled solver as shown in algorithm 1.

Algorithm 1 Sequential Coupled Solver

Let U^0 be given as initial data.

- 1: Initialize $\mathcal{U}^0$, compute $\mathcal{W}^0$ with eutectic phase package.
- 2: Compute ϕ^0 in $\mathcal{W}^0$, solve the Darcy-Stokes system (??)–(??) for $\mathcal{V}^0$.
- 3: **for** Time level $n = 1, 2, \dots, n_{\max} - 1$ **do**
- 4: Given $\mathcal{U}^n$, compute $\mathcal{W}^n$ by the eutectic phase package.
- 5: Compute ϕ^n in $\mathcal{W}^n$, solve the Darcy-Stokes system (??)–(??) for $\mathcal{V}^{n+1}$.
- 6: Given $\mathcal{W}^n$ and $\mathcal{V}^{n+1}$, compute dimensionless effective velocity (??) and phase averaged velocity as

$$\check{\mathbf{v}}_{\text{eff}} = \frac{\phi \check{\mathbf{v}}_l + D_i(1 - \phi) \check{\mathbf{v}}_s}{\phi + (1 - \phi)D_i}, \quad \check{\mathbf{v}} = \phi \check{\mathbf{v}}_r + \check{\mathbf{v}}_s.$$

- 7: Explicitly marching forward the transport system (??) to next time $n + 1$ for $\mathcal{U}^{n+1}$.
 - 8: **end for**
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2.1.1 Discontinuous Data

Due to the nature of the finite volume method, we may obtain different reconstructed dimensionless enthalpy and mass concentration values from two sides of an element edge and thus two different phase calculation results. It is crucial to have one compatible and appropriate porosity value used on the edge for the continuous compaction equation in Darcy equation with divergence theorem involved in equation (??). We employ geometric average for porosity ϕ_e on an element edge e as

$$\phi_e = \frac{2\phi_e^+ \phi_e^-}{\phi_e^+ + \phi_e^-}, \quad (2.1)$$

where ϕ_e^+ and ϕ_e^- are porosity evaluated from two sides of the element edge e . When the porosity on one side equal zero, the geometric average of the porosity equals zero as well, which highlights the fact that there is no liquid flow travelling through this edge.

2.2 Pseudo One-Dimensional Column Tests

In this section, we first test our coupled algorithm on a 2D $M \times N$ grid with a pseudo-1D column problem. We test two different scenarios, one couples MFEM and FVM solver without phase computation but a simple prescribed melting function instead. The other one exhibits a fully coupled scenario where phase transition and porosity evolution present.

2.2.1 Prescribed Melting Case

Before fully coupled computation, we illustrate a simpler model coupling case coupling MFEM and FVM solver. Instead of deciding porosity with phase package computation, we prescribe the melting rate or the change of porosity as a fixed function distributed in space as

$$\phi(t) = \Gamma(\mathbf{x}). \quad (2.2)$$

We write conservation of liquid mass with the prescribed melting term Γ (2.2) as

$$\frac{\partial \phi}{\partial t} + \nabla \cdot (\phi \mathbf{v}_l) = \Gamma, \quad (2.3)$$

where diffusion effect is being dropped for simplicity.

We perform a quasi-1D column test on a 2×40 rectangular physical domain $\Omega \in [-0.05, 0.05] \times [-0.4, 0]$. We prescribe the following boundary conditions for MFEM and FVM solver.

- Bottom side;
 - MFEM. We prescribe solid velocity at the bottom of the physical domain, indicating supplying of mantle.

$$\tilde{\mathbf{V}}_s = \mathbf{V}_{\text{upwelling}}.$$

We prescribe zero liquid velocity indicating no melting penetrating bottom of the computational domain;

- FVM. We prescribe a fixed inflow boundary condition, supplying composition and enthalpy into system.
- Left and right side;
 - MFEM. We prescribe natural boundary condition giving zero traction to the Stokes equation in tangential direction. We prescribe zero flux for dofs in normal direction for the Stokes equation and Darcy equation.
 - FVM. We prescribe noflow (zero flux) condition.
- Top side;
 - MFEM. We prescribe natural boundary condition given zero traction and zero pressure to Stokes and Darcy part respectively.
 - FVM. We set free outflow boundary if it is recognized as outflow. We set zero if the velocity reversed to inflow boundary condition.

For simplicity and efficiency in computation, we use 1×3 and 1×2 for our ML-WENO(3,2) stencils, since we don't need resolution and high order accuracy in x direction. We show two different melting source scenarios. One of which is a piece wise constant stair function:

$$\Gamma_1(z) = \begin{cases} 1e-3, & -0.2 < z \leq 0, \\ 5e-4, & -0.3 < z \leq -0.2, \\ 0, & -0.4 \leq z \leq -0.3, \end{cases} \quad (2.4)$$

and one with melting source trapped in the middle of the melting column as

$$\Gamma_2(z) = \begin{cases} 0, & -0.2 < z \leq 0, \\ 5e-4, & -0.3 < z \leq -0.2, \\ 0, & -0.4 \leq z \leq -0.3, \end{cases} \quad (2.5)$$

We assign different initial conditions to these two scenarios as

$$\phi_1(z, 0) = 0.0, \quad z \in [-0.4, 0.0], \quad (2.6)$$

and

$$\phi_2(z, 0) = \begin{cases} 1e - 2, & -0.2 < z \leq 0, \\ 0, & -0.4 \leq z \leq -0.2. \end{cases} \quad (2.7)$$

2.2.2 Phase Transition Case

2.3 Two-Dimensional Test

Works Cited

Harro Schmeling. Partial melting and melt segregation in a convecting mantle. pages 141–178, 2000. doi: 10.1007/978-94-011-4016-4_5. URL https://doi.org/10.1007/978-94-011-4016-4_5.